effects on the body of the consumer. Foods that grow under the ground, like onion and garlic, fall into the unhealthy tamasik category, along with meat, alcohol, coffee and tobacco.

9. In Tvastar's dwelling Indra drank the Soma, a hundredworth of juice pressed from the mortar, translated by Ralph T. H. Griffith.
10. Rutvij Merchant, 'Answering the ultimate question: who is a Hindu?', Firstpost.com, 24 September 2014.
11. See page 253.
12. K. Balasubramania Iyer, *Yaksha Prasna*, Bombay: Bhavan's Book Company, 1989.
13. I am indebted to Dr Nanditha Krishna for this insight.
14. Since the precise dates are impossible to establish, some authorities prefer a later date for the commencement of their composition.
15. Upinder Singh, *Political Violence in Ancient India*, Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 2017, p. 236.
16. 'Having taken the bow furnished by the *Upanishads*, the great weapon and fixed in it the arrow rendered pointed by constant meditation and having drawn it with the mind fixed on the *Brahman*, hit, good looking youth! at that mark the immortal *Brahman*'. www.wisdomlib.org
17. Raimon Panikkar, *The Vedic Experience*, p. 66.

3. QUESTIONING HINDU CUSTOMS

1. Radhakrishnan, *The Hindu Way of Life*, London: Geo. Allen & Unwin, 1927.
2. Manu S. Pillai, 'Women, Lingayats and "the Hindus"', *LiveMint*, 25 September 2017.
3. Manu S. Pillai, 'The Kerala of the past and present', *LiveMint*, 2 September 2017.
4. Seema Chishti, 'Biggest caste survey: One in four Indians admit to practising untouchability', *Indian Express*, 29 November 2014.
5. A scholar friend finds the figure for Christians surprisingly low. In Tamil Nadu, she tells me, many churches have separate pews and